

## Smart development means eco smart

India and Japan have agreed to **deepen** maritime cooperation in shipbuilding, port development and maritime training for a 'globally **sustainable** future'. As part of this vision, the two countries discussed **deploying** sustainable technologies, **disaster-resilient infrastructure** and improved connectivity to transform the Andaman & Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep into 'Smart Islands'. This means **incorporating** RE, digital infrastructure and smart **mobility** systems. Japan has also shown interest in port digitisation and green port initiatives. Beyond **economics**, these **plans** to develop the islands **align with** India's Indo-Pacific **ambitions**. **All in all**, this holds great **potential**.

But even as plans are **in the works**, it's important to consider their potential impact, especially **given** that these are among India's most **ecologically** sensitive regions. Development is a **must** for all people, the Andamanese and Nicobarese included. And Japan's **expertise** in sustainable infra **is well-regarded**. But, understandably, there are concerns. **Remote** and irreplaceable, these islands are home to **delicate ecosystems**. **Critics** of the controversial Great Nicobar Island Development Project have long warned that even **unintended** disruptions here could have irreversible consequences. The recent oil **spill off** Kerala's **coast** - when cargo ship MSC ELSA 3 **sank** with over 450 t of fuel oil and **hazardous** chemicals - **serves** as a **stark** reminder.



Environmental loss is no **abstraction**. It also brings with it **demographic** and cultural **erosion**. Every rupee spent on **short-sighted** projects risks a much higher cost when nature **retaliates**. A **tech-heavy** smart island plan mustn't ignore environmental realities, especially for developmental reasons that go beyond the short term.

**[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

## Vocabulary

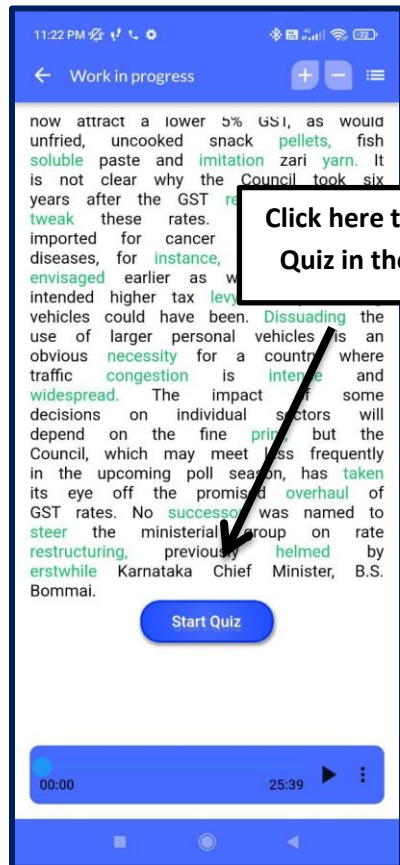
1. **Deepen** (verb) – strengthen, enhance, expand, intensify, widen गहरा करना
2. **Sustainable** (adjective) – eco-friendly, renewable, green, viable, enduring टिकाऊ
3. **Deploy** (verb) – implement, use, position, utilize, employ तैनात करना / लागू करना
4. **Disaster-resilient** (adjective) – robust, disaster-proof, durable, tough, crisis-ready आपदा-प्रतिरोधी
5. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, foundation, facilities, base, system आधारभूत संरचना
6. **Incorporate** (verb) – include, integrate, combine, merge, assimilate सम्मिलित करना
7. **Mobility** (noun) – movement, transport, travel, locomotion, portability गतिशीलता
8. **Economics** (noun) – financials, economy, fiscal matters, commerce, trade अर्थव्यवस्था
9. **Align** (with) (verb) – match, coordinate, correspond, fit, conform संरेखित करना
10. **Ambition** (noun) – aspiration, goal, dream, aim, objective महत्वाकांक्षा
11. **All in all** (phrase) – overall, generally, on the whole, in total, in summary कुल मिलाकर
12. **Potential** (noun) – possibility, capability, promise, prospect, capacity क्षमता
13. **In the works** (phrase) – being prepared, underway, in process, planned, upcoming प्रक्रिया में
14. **Given** (preposition) – considering, taking into account, in view of, due to, keeping in mind को देखते हुए
15. **Ecologically** (adverb) – environmentally, sustainably, biologically, naturally, ecosystem-wise पारिस्थितिक रूप से
16. **Must** (noun) – necessity, essential, requirement, imperative, need आवश्यक चीज
17. **Expertise** (noun) – skill, knowledge, proficiency, specialization, competence विशेषज्ञता
18. **Well-regarded** (adjective) – respected, esteemed, admired, reputable, appreciated सम्मानित / प्रशंसित
19. **Remote** (adjective) – distant, far-off, isolated, secluded, inaccessible दूरस्थ
20. **Delicate** (adjective) – fragile, sensitive, tender, subtle, easily damaged नाजुक

21. **Ecosystem** (noun) – environment, habitat, ecological system, biosphere, natural system पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र
22. **Critics** (noun) – opponents, reviewers, commentators, detractors, analysts आलोचक
23. **Unintended** (adjective) – accidental, unplanned, unexpected, inadvertent, unforeseen अनजाना / अनचाहा
24. **Spill** (noun) – leakage, outflow, overflow, discharge, emission रिसाव
25. **Off** (preposition) – near, beside, adjacent to, close to, offshore के पास / तट के पास
26. **Sink** (verb) – submerge, go under, plunge, descend, founder डूब जाना
27. **Hazardous** (adjective) – dangerous, risky, unsafe, toxic, harmful खतरनाक
28. **Stark** (adjective) – harsh, clear, blunt, severe, unmistakable कठोर / सख्त / स्पष्ट
29. **Abstraction** (noun) – theory, idea, concept, generality, intangibility अमूर्तता / सैद्धांतिक चीज़
30. **Demographic** (adjective) – population-related, societal, statistical, ethnographic, census-based जनसंख्या संबंधी
31. **Erosion** (noun) – deterioration, loss, decline, wearing away, degradation क्षरण
32. **Short-sighted** (adjective) – unwise, imprudent, narrow-minded, rash, careless अदूरदर्शी
33. **Retaliate** (verb) – strike back, take revenge, respond, react, avenge बदला लेना
34. **Tech-heavy** (adjective) – technology-focused, high-tech, digitally-intensive, tech-centric, innovation-based तकनीक-प्रधान

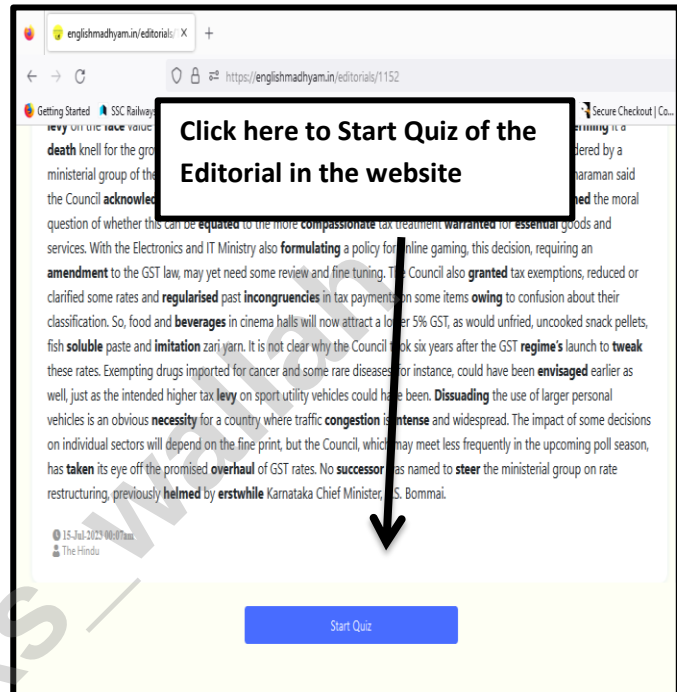
### Summary of the Editorial

1. India and Japan have agreed to deepen maritime cooperation, including shipbuilding, port development, and training.
2. Both countries envision a 'globally sustainable future' by promoting environmentally responsible infrastructure.
3. They aim to transform Andaman & Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep into 'Smart Islands' using renewable energy, digital infrastructure, and smart mobility systems.
4. Japan has also expressed interest in port digitisation and green port initiatives.
5. These development plans also support India's Indo-Pacific strategic goals, beyond just economic benefits.
6. While the plans are promising, there is concern about their environmental impact on these ecologically sensitive regions.
7. The Andamanese and Nicobarese people also deserve development, but it must be inclusive and sustainable.
8. Japan's record in sustainable infrastructure offers hope for a responsible model.
9. However, the islands are home to fragile and irreplaceable ecosystems that must be protected.
10. Critics cite the Great Nicobar Island Development Project as a warning of potential ecological disruption.
11. The oil spill from MSC ELSA 3 off the Kerala coast recently highlights the dangers of poor planning and oversight.
12. Environmental damage can also result in demographic and cultural loss, especially in indigenous communities.
13. Short-sighted development risks triggering long-term ecological and economic consequences.
14. The editorial emphasizes that tech-heavy projects must not ignore ground ecological realities.
15. True smart development means being eco-smart, balancing growth with long-term environmental sustainability.

## Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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